

THE
COMMUNICATIONS
AND ELECTRONICS BRANCH

95 CRAFTSMAN BOULEVARD
CFB KINGSTON, ONTARIO, K7K 7B4



BRANCHE
DES COMMUNICATIONS
ET DE L'ÉLECTRONIQUE

95 CRAFTSMAN BOULEVARD
BFC KINGSTON, ONTARIO, K7K 7B4

1000-5 (Br Adjt)

21 Nov 2022

Distribution List

SENATE MEETING
RECORD OF DECISIONS – FRIDAY, 28 OCTOBER 2022

RECORD OF ATTENDANCE

POSITION / APPOINTMENT	RANK & NAME
Chair / Colonel Commandant	Brigadier-General Josée Robidoux (Retired)
Co-Chair / Branch Leader	Brigadier-General Dave Yarker
Member / Previous Colonel Commandant	Brigadier-General Kevin O'Keefe (Retired) (REGRETS)
Member / Branch Advisor	Colonel John Roper
Member / Branch Chief	Chief Warrant Officer Alex Arndt
Member / Previous Branch Chief	Chief Warrant Officer Gilles Philibert (REGRETS)
Member / Association President	Major-General John Leech (Retired)
Member / Foundation President	Mr. Scott Mclean (REGRETS)
Member / Serving General Officer	Brigadier-General Denis Boucher
Member / Serving General Officer	Brigadier-General Pascal Godbout
Member / Serving General Officer	Brigadier-General Patrice Sabourin (REGRETS)
Member / Serving General Officer	Brigadier-General Justin Thibert (REGRETS)
Member / Honorary Rep	Colonel Ken Lloyd (REGRETS)
Member / CO C&E Museum	Lieutenant-Colonel Bahir Ali
Guest / Museum Rep	Major Geoff Priems
Secretariat / Branch Adjutant	Major Gavin Ellis

OPENING REMARKS

1. Opening of Meeting:

The Colonel Commandant (Col Cmdt) opened the meeting at 1335 and offered initial opening remarks to the Branch Leader.

2. Branch Leader:

Opted not to provide opening remarks as “sufficient words have been said over the past week”.

3. Colonel Commandant:

Indicating that the full week of activities was a benefit to the Branch and it was great to see everyone face to face.

REVIEW & APPROVAL OF PRIOR ROD

4. Colonel Commandant:

Approved as written.

OLD BUSINESS I – BATTLEFIELD STUDY TOUR 2023

5. Branch Advisor:

60 of 62 seats are filled and organizers are working to fill the remaining seats.

Excellent representation from all Communications and Electronics (C&E) Branch units and environments.

Just over \$43,000 has been paid to Merrit travel as an initial down payment and to cover travel insurance. \$137,000 is due by the end of January to complete full payment.

6. Branch Leader:

As Op DISTINCTION has been stood down, which activity or operation is the tour being linked to? Op DISTINCTION previously enabled the approval of an event and use of public funds for the three organizing members.

ACTION ITEM(s):

7. Branch Adjutant:

Work with the Battlefield Study Tour organizers to determine a way forward for event approval.

OLD BUSINESS II – HRH VISIT

8. Colonel Commandant:

Her Royal Highness is awaiting official travel confirmation, no other changes were reported since the last update.

Proposal continues to be a Signals contingent (x50) on parade and 1 hour private audience with gala attendance.

OLD BUSINESS III – C&E FAMILY SURVEY

9. Colonel Commandant:

The survey results were not what was originally expected. The Col Cmdt intends to do something about this and will put time and interest into a plan after looking into the remainder of the survey submissions. The aim is to come back to the Senate and outline a plan / proposal to tackle Branch identity & morale issues. Looking forward the intent is not to conduct additional surveys but to gather information through Meet & Greet and other discussion related activities.

NEW BUSINESS I – BRANCH REPORT

10. Branch Adjutant:

Provided a summary of financial expenditures as per Annex A Slide 3. Highlighted during this summary was the limited number of funds being requested from the Branch Distress Fund and Branch Educational Bursaries program.

11. Colonel Commandant:

It was asked if the bursary program was still relevant and required. The Branch Leader indicated that while in the position of branch advisor the branch would receive 12-24 requests for funds. It was also noted that the C&E Educational Bursaries program was not listed with other Canadian Armed Forces branch bursaries on Canada.ca, Support our Troops and CF Appreciation. It is

thought that an improved communications plan and improved C&E Branch Battle Rhythm that could advertise activities, events and deadlines to the membership will improve overall use of branch services.

ACTION ITEM(s):

12. Branch Adjutant:

Determine where C&E Educational Bursaries can be advertised outside of the C&E Branch website and have the branch bursaries added.

Develop a timeline of all Branch meetings, activities and deadlines for Honours & Recognition ensuring that they line up properly with outside timelines such as annually posting season, post-secondary school application approvals and C&E Week.

NEW BUSINESS II – MUSEUM REPORT

13. OC Museum:

As per presentation found in Annex A slides 4-12.

14. Branch Advisor:

Memorandum of Understanding (MOU) between the Royal Canadian Electrical and Mechanical Engineers (RCEME) Branch has been reviewed and commented. The MOU is now with the RCEME Branch for final review.

NEW BUSINESS III – FOUNDATION REPORT

15. Foundation President:

Not present for the Senate meeting.

16. Colonel Commandant:

Motioned to strike the previous action item regarding the Foundation Honour Roll including entry criteria. After a discussion and an email from the Foundation president, provided by Brigadier-

General Godbout (Annex B), which indicates that there are gaps in the Branch books of remembrance. The email recommends the branch decide:

- a. if a unified Honour Roll or a supplementary document to capture the gaps;
- b. what criteria should be used when adding names to the Honour Roll: killed in combat, killed on duty, died while serving, deceased combat veterans, deceased non-combat veterans; and
- c. who should be OPI to implement the approved option?

ACTION ITEM(s):

17. Branch Adjutant:

Develop a recommendation for Senate approval as to a how gaps within the Branch Honour Roll should be captured based on the information provided.

NEW BUSINESS IV – ASSOCIATION REPORT

18. Major-General (Ret'd) Leech:

As per slide 13 at Annex A:

- a. continue heritage activities
 - 1) awards
 - 2) NL 75th Anniversary plaque
- b. expand professional development
- c. participate in fundraising
- d. expand member services

19. Key points from Association presentation:

- a. association to work on means to exploit current retired community;
- b. association is a link to industry partners that can be leveraged for branch benefit;
- c. develop and enable virtual support teams for CMCEN and other activities, example of LCol Eric Essellaar, who originally stood up CMCEN, was used.

ALCON

20. Brigadier-General Boucher

Discussed the potential to develop a C&E App similar to that related to the CAF and being developed by CFSCE for their digital campus. Advantages of having a platform used by the new generation that can be leveraged to push notifications and reminder of Branch activities. Discussion included a branch communications plan and seeking advice as to how to develop such a plan.

21. Throughout discussion related to C&E Week and means to better communicate to the membership a number of action items were developed and are documented below.

ACTION ITEM(s):

22. Branch Adjutant:

- a. ensure list of recently retired members are included in C&E Branch Mess Dinners, normally at the back of dinner pamphlet;
- b. next C&E Week dates, activities and event instructions to be released in a reasonable time to enable maximum participation;
- c. provide summary to Senate and BAC as to C&E Week participation, both in person and online;
- d. explore the potential of displaying different forms of informational media on CMCEN for membership intake including, reading lists, podcasts, briefings, videos, twits, etc;
- e. engage with IM Gp Communications and ADM(PA) on the development of a Branch communications plan and hiring of communications consultant; and
- f. review and note lessons and action items from old Senate and BAC meetings to prevent a repeat of action and work by the Branch. Make them available to Branch leadership.

23. Branch Advisor

- a. BAC Agenda item: Discuss and determine the following for C&E Week:
 - 1) center of Mass;
 - 2) themes; and
 - 3) identify who the week should be tailored towards.

CLOSING REMARKS

24. No closing remarks were made and the meeting was closed at 1506.

Brigadier-General Josée Robidoux, OMM, CD (Retired)
Branch Colonel Commandant

Brigadier-General Dave Yarker, CD
Branch Leader

Annexes:

Annex A Branch Senate Slide Deck
Annex B Email “Book of Remembrance” Steve Sibbald 28 October 2021
Annex C List of Action Items

Annex A
1000-5 (Br Adj)
November 2022

ANNEX A: BRANCH SENATE SLIDE DECK

C&E BRANCH SENATE MEETING



Friday, 28 1330 October 2022

Slide 1

AGENDA:

- ▶ Opening Remarks (**Branch Leadership**)
- ▶ Review and Approval of Previous Minutes (**Colonel Commandant**)
- ▶ Old Business I - Netherlands 2023 Update (**Branch Advisor**)
- ▶ Old Business II - HRH Visit 2023 Update (**Colonel Commandant**)
- ▶ Old Business III - C&E Family Survey: Next Steps (**Colonel Commandant**)
- ▶ New Business I - Branch Report (**Branch Advisor & Branch Adjutant**)
- ▶ New Business II - Museum Report (**Officer Commanding Museum**)
- ▶ New Business III - Foundation Report (**Foundation President**)
- ▶ New Business IV - Association Report (**Association President**)
- ▶ Closing Remarks (**ALCON**)

Slide 2

A - 1/7

Branch Fund Report: \$8,209.69

► Current Balance: \$8,209.69

Funds Expended (Jun - Oct)

- \$0.00 Distress Fund
- \$440.00 Ceremony & Morale
- \$1,745.85 Trophies & Plaques
- \$0.00 Educational Bursaries(\$1,000 expected)
- \$680.00 Events
- \$0.00 CMCEN (all paid for the year)
- \$0 Subaltern & Member of the Year
- \$0.00 Postage & Stamps
- \$44.35 Bank Fees & Miscellaneous

Slide 3

C&E MUSEUM:

1. General
2. Upcoming Events
3. Financial Update
4. Museum Posture
5. Covid Rules Posture



Slide 4

General

- ▶ OC Museum - Maj Priems - arrived 17 Jan.
 - ▶ 2 x Museum Committee Meetings
 - ▶ 1 x Board of Directors Meeting
 - ▶ 1 x Volunteer Welcome Back Event
 - ▶ CFSCE DCmdt task from 15 Jul-21 Oct
- ▶ Policy Approvals
 - ▶ Admissions Policy and Procedure Approval
 - ▶ Volunteer Policy
 - ▶ Adopt a Display Policy (single/multiyear; and special program)
- ▶ Website Launch: www.candemuseum.org
- ▶ RCEME MOU renewal (ongoing)



Slide 5

Upcoming Events

- ▶ RCEME MOU signing - tbd
- ▶ 11 Nov Remembrance Day - Good parade observation point, and post parade reception -
- ▶ 12 Nov - Foundation Gala Event - www.mmfoundation.ca/gala
- ▶ Operation Jimmy Santa support
- ▶ Review of Museum Constitution
- ▶ Museum Committee meeting - tbd, aiming late Nov/early Dec
- ▶ 5 year Strategic Plan Draft - likely early 2023 for Br Advisor
- ▶ Annual Operation Plan - for Feb 2023

Slide 6

CFMWS provided to pay staff to remain at home. This “preserved” our staff from layoff, and allowed us to not have to lose staff, and go through hiring process

Slide 8

Museum Development Fund 2022

- ▶ DHH -Total request - \$1.738M (submitted, not approved)
 - ▶ Permanent Exhibit Renewal Study - \$50k
 - ▶ Display Acquisition (based on recommendations from study)- \$900k
 - ▶ Museum Storage (rolling shelves)- \$500k
 - ▶ Interpretive Panels and Signs - \$250k
 - ▶ Website Maintenance - \$10k
 - ▶ Conservation Supplies - \$25k
 - ▶ OMMC travel for 2 - \$3k

Slide 9

Museum Status

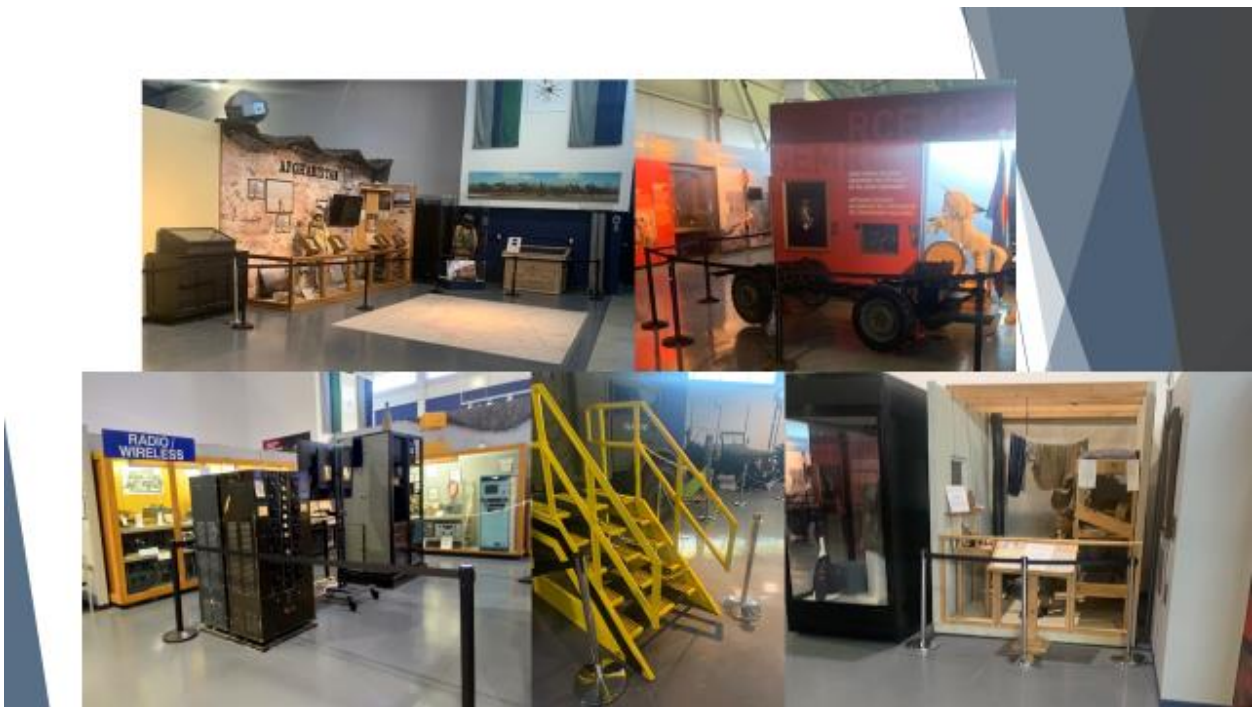
- ▶ Current status:
 - ▶ Masks are a personal choice.
 - ▶ Physical distancing recommended; one meter required for PSP staff
 - ▶ Hours: M-F 10am-3:30pm (May long weekend to Sept long weekend - open 7 days a week).
- ▶ Gallery Changes:
 - ▶ Plastic removed from all items
 - ▶ Barriers will remain in place for the foreseeable future until posture change by CMA/CCI/OMA
 - ▶ Some exhibits will remain inaccessible until plexiglass barriers have been created

Slide 10

Current COVID Posture



Slide 11



Slide 12

C&E ASSOCIATION

- ▶ Continue heritage Activities
 - ▶ Awards
 - ▶ NL 75th Anniversary plaque
- ▶ Expand Professional Development
- ▶ Participate in Fundraising
- ▶ Expand Member Services

Slide 13

Annex B
1000-5 (Br Adj)
November 2022

ANNEX B: EMAIL

“BOOK OF REMEMBRANCE” STEVE SIBBALD 28 OCTOBER 2021

Godbout BGen JPP@JTFN HQ@Yellowknife

From: Steve Sibbald <swsibbald@hotmail.com>
Sent: October 28, 2021 12:28 PM
To: Lambert BGen DJ@ADM(IM) DGIMO@Ottawa-Hull; Paquin Maj CC@ADM(IM) DGIMO@Ottawa-Hull; Roper Col JA@ADM(Mat) DAEPM(R&CS)@Ottawa-Hull; Philibert CWO GR@ADM(IM) COS(IM)@Ottawa-Hull; john.leech@cmcen.ca; Sabourin BGen PC@ADM(IM) DG Cyber@Ottawa-Hull; Godbout BGen JPP@JTFN HQ@Yellowknife; Awalt WO MA@CFJSR 1 Sqn@Kingston; wsrichard@cogeco.ca; kenlloyd.mediator@gmail.com; Ali LCol B@CFSCE-EECF@Kingston; Robidoux JDM@SJS Strat Init Coord@Ottawa-Hull
Cc: Peter Scott; Annette Gillis; Karen Young; Scott McLean; Mark Lilienthal
Subject: Book of Remembrance

Hello all;
Below is the gist of the new item I brought up at this afternoon's Senate meeting.
I propose that we discuss, appoint an OPI, and provide direction.
Cheers
Steve

+++++

1. It has been brought to my attention that there are gaps in the Branch's books of remembrance.
 2. We currently have three books:
 - a. RCCS Book of Remembrance, goes up to 1960
 - b. Afghanistan Honour Roll
 - c. Sigs Club Book of RemembranceBut this leaves significant gaps.
 3. It is my understanding the Joe Costello has been working on a list, and coordinating with the museum staff.
 4. I propose that the Branch decide:
 - a. if we want a unified Honour Roll or a supplementary one for the gaps;
 - b. what criteria should be used: killed in combat, killed on duty, died while serving, deceased combat veterans, deceased non-combat veterans; and
 - c. who should be OPI to implement.
-

Annex C
1000-5 (Br Adj)
November 2022

ANNEX C: LIST OF ACTION ITEMS

1. **Branch Adjutant:** Work with the Battlefield Study Tour operators to determine a way forward for event approval.
2. **Branch Adjutant:** Determine where C&E Educational Bursaries can be advertised outside of the C&E Branch website and have the branch bursaries added.
3. **Branch Adjutant:** Develop a recommendation or Senate approval as to how the gaps within the Branch Honour Roll should be captured based on the information provided.
4. **Branch Adjutant:** Ensure list of recently retired members are included in C&E Branch Mess Dinners, normally at the back of dinner pamphlet.
5. **Branch Adjutant:** Next C&E Week dates, activities and event instructions to be released in a reasonable time to enable maximum participation.
6. **Branch Adjutant:** Provide summary to Senate and BAC as to C&E Week participation, both in person and online.
7. **Branch Adjutant:** Explore the potential of displaying different forms of informational media on CMCEN for membership intake including, reading lists, podcasts, briefings, videos, twits, etc.
8. **Branch Adjutant:** Engage with IM Gp Communications and ADM(PA) on the development of a Branch communications plan and hiring of communications consultant.
9. **Branch Adjutant:** Review and note lessons and action items from old Senate and BAC meetings to prevent a repeat of action and work by the Branch. Make them available to Branch leadership.
10. **Branch Advisor:** BAC Agenda item - Discuss and determine the following for C&E Week:
 - a. Center of Mass
 - b. Themes
 - c. Identify who the week should be tailored towards.